

OnePlus 13s

Making Small Phones Cool Again

The OnePlus 13s enters a market that's increasingly divided into phones that are either pushing flagship specs to the extreme or cutting corners to hit lower price tags. In the middle of that noise, the OnePlus 13s tries to do something less trendy: bring flagship-level performance into a compact, usable body. No foldable screens, no 200-megapixel camera hype, just a smartphone with some smart choices and a few missed opportunities. So, does that make it worth the Rs 54,999 asking price?

ONEPLUS 13S DESIGN: A PHONE THAT ACTUALLY FITS

The first thing you'll notice is the size, or lack of it. At 185g and just 8.1mm thick, this phone slips into your pocket without sticking out or begging to fall. It's well-balanced too. Not just in hand (though the weight distribution is spot on), but in daily use. Typing one-handed, walking with a coffee, watching reels sideways in bed, it just works. No hand cramps, no aerial gymnastics to take a one-handed pic.

The 13s genuinely feels compact without being cramped, and pocketability is a real strength here; it just fits. The Velvet Glass back is grippy but not slippery, and the symmetrical design with minimal branding keeps things clean. It doesn't try too hard to stand out, which oddly makes it more likeable.

One tweak worth noting is the "the Plus Key" replaces the alert slider. It's tied to an AI feature called "Mind Space," and lets you capture and retrieve content from your screen. Not everyone will use it, but it's pretty functional.

₹54,999



ONEPLUS 13S DISPLAY: SOLID PERFORMANCE WITH CHARACTER

The 6.7-inch LTPO OLED panel isn't the brightest out there (peaking at 1700 nits), but it performs well outdoors except in direct sunlight.

It looks natural, not overly saturated, and Dolby Vision support enhances for HDR viewing.

In our Calman display tests, colour accuracy was solid, with an average Delta E of 1.3 and 99.3% sRGB coverage. The screen is vivid and punchy, especially with reds and blues—noticeable in app icons, UI highlights, and thumbnails. It feels a bit more cinematic. Not fake, just... a little more drama.

The OnePlus 13s also shows a visible blue dominance at higher luminance levels, which may cause whites to appear slightly cooler in everyday use, which is great for movies or Instagram but less ideal for colour-sensitive tasks.

The display is smooth, well-calibrated, and usable even in moderately bright outdoor conditions. Bonus: it works with wet hands and gloves, and is helpful during monsoons or when you have cold fingers in Manali.

ONEPLUS 13S PERFORMANCE & SOFTWARE: A CHIP THAT DOESN'T FLINCH

The OnePlus 13s runs on the Snapdragon 8 Elite with 12GB of RAM, and it provides more than enough power. The benchmarks are predictably strong and honestly embarrass phones twice its price.

- AnTuTu: 2,512,830
- Geekbench multi-core: 8,825
- CPU Throttling: 86%
- 3DMark Wild Life: 6,472

But it's the real-world speed that stands out. Multitasking is smooth, and apps stay in memory. You can jump from Genshin to Instagram mid-battle, reply to a message, return, and nothing skips a beat.

BGMI runs at a consistent 120FPS for almost the whole session. Even the minimum was 105 FPS, which most phones can't even hit as a peak, with temperatures staying around 37°C even after longer sessions. The cooling system, which comprises a vapour chamber plus a graphite layer, does its job without making a show of it.

There is thermal throttling under sustained load, so creators doing video edits or gaming and screen recording simultaneously might notice a dip. But for most users, it won't be a dealbreaker.

On the software front, it runs OxygenOS 15 and comes with its own AI layer. Not just Gemini, which it has, but also OnePlus AI. You get a dedicated Plus Key that lets you save anything you see into your "Mind Space."

You get smart features like AI text summaries, live call transcriptions, and visual search—but they don't get in the way. Most tasks run on-device, so everything stays fast and private.

The updates are the same as what OnePlus offers: four years of OS updates and six years of security patches.